

DAY 19: LOWER PRESCRIPTION DRUG COSTS

There was a period in time when both Joseph and I didn't have any health insurance at all. He had started a new job, and we were surprised to find out the waiting period was at least three months before the insurance plan kicked in. There wasn't much else we could do besides put ourselves on the "don't get sick" plan, and try to avoid dangerous situations that could result in a broken bone—not that we seek these opportunities anyway! What we didn't know was how we were going to afford the medications I was on in the meantime.

It was during these three months that I did a *ton* of research on how to cut costs and make prescriptions affordable. But pharmacies didn't always want to work with us, and the costs for certain meds were still really, really high. Even now, the insurance plan I have requires a fairly high deductible before any of the copays kick in. This, paired with a long list of side effects, often makes me wonder whether it's worth taking any medication at all!

Maybe you've been in, or currently find yourself in a similar spot. I know it can feel like you're trapped in an endless cycle—you need your prescription, but you can't afford it. Then you either fall further behind in your bills, or take dangerous measures like skipping doses and cutting pills in half without talking to your doctor first.

No matter what your prescription situation looks like right now, there's always a way to trim this portion of your budget, even if it's just a little. You don't have to settle for full price anymore, not when there are so many affordable options available to you!

1. ASK FOR SAMPLES

If you don't have insurance, or have a high deductible, it never hurts to ask for free samples at the doctor's office. This is especially helpful if you are prescribed a new medication and don't know the cost of it yet, or don't have time to shop around.